

Trinitarianism and Monotheism: One God in Three Hypostases

By Dn Yonnas · Holy Trinity · Youth & Young Adults

Summary

A defense and explanation of how the Church worships one God while confessing three Hypostases. The lesson answers the accusation that Christians worship three gods, defines 'Hypostasis,' walks through the distinct work of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit in our salvation, and corrects common misunderstandings.

Lesson Objectives

- Show from Scripture that the Christian faith is fully monotheistic
- Define 'Hypostasis' and explain the three Hypostases without separation or ranking
- Recognize and answer common misunderstandings about the Trinity

Key Bible Verses

Deuteronomy 6:4 — "Hear, O Israel: The Lord our God, the Lord is one."

John 10:30 — "I and My Father are one."

Matthew 28:19 — baptism in the one Name of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit

Main Teaching Points

- We believe in one God — never three gods, and never one Person wearing three masks
- Hypostasis means a real personal distinction within the one God
- The Three are equal in honor, divinity, and eternity; none comes before another in time
- The Father wills and sends, the Son redeems and restores, the Holy Spirit sanctifies and gives life
- Analogies (the sun's disc, light, and heat) help — but God remains greater than every comparison
- Baptism is a Trinitarian new birth, not a mere symbol

Key Terms

- **Hypostasis** — A Greek theological term for a real personal distinction within the one God — a distinct personal reality, not a separate god.
- **Monotheism** — Belief in one God. Orthodox Trinitarian faith is fully monotheistic.
- **Trinity** — The one God eternally existing as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit — one in essence, three in Hypostases.

Discussion & Reflection

- Why do some people misunderstand the Trinity as belief in three gods?
- How does Matthew 28:19 show both unity and distinction?
- Why is it important to say the Persons are distinct but never divided?